“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 15

The Lord’s Pastime in the Garden

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 In the unfathomable ocean of feelings for Kṛṣṇa, Gaurahari’s heart now sank and now rose; and so He revealed the greatness of prema in all its fullness.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the Supreme Lord! Glory to Nityānanda, whose body is full of bliss!

3 Glory to Advaitācārya, most dear to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Glory to Śrīvāsa and all the Lord’s devotees!

4 In this way, night and day, Mahāprabhu was so absorbed in love for Kṛṣṇa that He had no awareness of Himself.

5 Sometimes He was immersed in feeling, sometimes half aware of the outer world, sometimes fully aware of it: the Lord passed through these three states.

6 Bathing, going to see Lord Jagannātha and eating went on of themselves, by the body’s own nature, as a potter’s wheel keeps turning.[2]

7 One day, when the Lord went to see Lord Jagannātha, He beheld in Him the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

8 At once the five qualities of Kṛṣṇa appeared to the Lord, and they drew His five senses to themselves.[3]

9 The five qualities pulled His one mind in five directions, and, torn this way and that, the Lord lost consciousness.

10 At that time Lord Jagannātha's *upala-bhoga* offering came to an end, and the devotees brought Mahāprabhu home.

11 With these two, Svarūpa and Rāmānanda, He lamented, His arms around their necks.

12 In separation from Kṛṣṇa, Rādhā's mind was restless with longing, and She told Viśākhā the cause of it.

13 Reciting that verse Himself, the Lord poured out the anguish of His heart, and lamenting, He explained its meaning to the two of them.

14 "O friend, with the waves of the nectar ocean of His beauty He floods the hills of women's hearts; His playful, charming words delight the ear; His body is cooler than millions of moons; with a nectar flood of fragrance He has covered the world; His lips are lovelier than nectar — that son of the king of the cowherds draws all five of My senses by force." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.3)[4]

15 "Kṛṣṇa's form, His voice, His touch, His fragrance and the taste of His lips — their sweetness cannot be described. Seeing them, the five, in their greed, mount a single horse — My mind — and ride off in five directions.

16 O friend, hear the cause of My sorrow. My five senses are utterly greedy robbers: they all say, ‘Steal another’s wealth!’[5]

17 One horse, and at one moment the five pull it in five directions — which way is the one mind to run? When all pull at once, the horse’s life departs. I cannot bear this pain.

18 I am not angry with My senses — what fault is theirs? Kṛṣṇa’s form and the rest attract with great force. The five — His form and the rest — pull the five senses; the horse’s life is ebbing, and life will not stay in My body.

19 The beauty of Kṛṣṇa is an ocean of nectar; a single drop of its waves drowns the world. The hearts of all the women in the three worlds are high mountains: it drowns them and surges on beyond.

20 The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa’s words, full of jests in many moods, is unjust beyond telling. Entering the ears of the world’s women, it binds them with the rope of its sweetness and pulls, and in that tug-of-war the ears lose their very life.[6]

21 Kṛṣṇa’s body is so cool — what can I say of its power? With its rays it surpasses millions of moons and sandal paste. Skilled at drawing the mountain-like breasts of women, it draws their minds as well.

22 Kṛṣṇa’s body is laden with fragrance; it humbles charming musk and robs the blue lotus of its wealth of pride. It makes its home in the nostrils of the world’s women and draws them to itself.

23 The nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips, with the camphor of His gentle smile, steals women’s minds by its own sweetness. It takes away all longing for anything else; not obtaining it, the mind is in turmoil. It is the chief wealth of the women of Vraja.”

24 Saying this, Gaurahari threw His arms around the necks of the two and said, “Listen, Svarūpa and Rāmarāya: what shall I do, where shall I go? Where can I go to find Kṛṣṇa? Both of you, tell Me how!”

25 In this way, day after day, the Lord Gaura lamented with Svarūpa and Rāmānanda.

26 Those two consoled the Lord: Svarūpa sang songs, and Rāya recited verses.

27 With the verses and songs of the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, of Vidyāpati and of the *Śrī Gīta-govinda* they gave the Lord joy.

28 One day, on His way to the sea, Mahāprabhu suddenly saw a flower garden.

29 Taking it for Vṛndāvana, He ran into it, and absorbed in prema He wandered there searching for Kṛṣṇa,

30 just as, when Kṛṣṇa disappeared from the rāsa dance taking Rādhā with Him, the gopīs afterwards wandered about searching for Him.

31 Absorbed in that mood, the Lord wandered here and there searching, reciting verse after verse to each tree and creeper:

32 “O *cūta*, *priyāla*, *panasa*, *āsana* and *kovidāra*, *jambu*, *arka*, *bilva*, *bakula*, mango, kadamba and *nīpa*, and all you other trees on the banks of the Yamunā, whose life is for the good of others — tell us, who have lost our very selves, which way Kṛṣṇa went!” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.9)

33 “O auspicious tulasī, dear to Govinda’s feet! Have you seen Acyuta, who holds you so dear, pass by wearing you, with swarms of bees around Him?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.7)

34 "O *mālatī*, O *mallikā*, O *jāti*, O *yūthikā*! Have you seen Mādhava pass by, giving you joy with the touch of His hand?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.8)

35 "O mango, *panasa*, *piyāla*, *jambu* and *kovidāra*! You all dwell in a holy place — so do good to others.[7]

36 Did Kṛṣṇa come here to you? Did you see Him? Tell us where Kṛṣṇa is and save our lives!"

37 Receiving no answer, they reasoned again: "These are all male, just like Kṛṣṇa's friends.

38 Why would they tell us where Kṛṣṇa is? But these creepers are female, almost our friends.

39 They will surely tell us — they have seen Kṛṣṇa." Reasoning thus, they questioned the tulasī and the other plants:

40 "O tulasī, *mālatī*, *yūthī*, *mādhavī* and *mallikā*! Did your beloved Kṛṣṇa come near you?

41 You are all like our friends. Tell us where Kṛṣṇa is, all of you, and save our lives!"

42 Receiving no answer, they thought within themselves: "These are Kṛṣṇa's maidservants; out of fear they will not tell us."

43 Ahead they saw some does, and catching the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa's body, they looked at their faces and, now certain, questioned them:

44 "O friend, O doe, did Acyuta come this way with His beloved, delighting your eyes with the beauty of His limbs? For here blows the fragrance of

our Lord's *kunda* garland, reddened with *kuṅkuma* from His beloved's breasts as He held Her close." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.11)[8]

45 "Tell us, O doe: did Śrī Kṛṣṇa come here with Rādhā to give you every joy? Do not tell us otherwise.

46 We are Rādhā's dear friends, not outsiders; even from afar we know the fragrance of His body.

47 The air is scented with the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa's *kunda* garland, adorned with *kuṅkuma* from Rādhā's breasts as He embraced Her.

48 Kṛṣṇa has left this place, and she is pining in separation. What answer can she give? She does not even hear our words."

49 Ahead they saw trees whose branches had all bent down to the earth under the weight of flowers and fruits.

50 Concluding that all these trees had bowed down on seeing Kṛṣṇa, they asked them, to be sure, which way He had gone:

51 "O trees, did Rāma's younger brother pass this way, His arm on His beloved's shoulder and a lotus in His hand, followed by swarms of bees from His tulasī garland, blind with intoxication? And as He passed, did He welcome your obeisances with loving glances?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.12)[9]

52 As bees settled on His beloved's face, He waved His pastime lotus to drive them away, and His mind was distracted.

53 Did He pay any attention to your obeisances, or did He not? Tell us — give us your word as proof.

54 These servants are grieving in separation from Kṛṣṇa. What answer can they give? They are not even conscious."

55 Saying this, they went on to the bank of the Yamunā, and there they saw Kṛṣṇa beneath a kadamba tree.

56 He enchants millions of gods of love; the flute is at His lips; with His boundless beauty He steals the eyes and minds of the whole world.

57 Seeing that beauty, the Lord fell to the ground in a swoon. Just then Svarūpa and the others arrived and found Him.

58 As before, all the sāttvika-bhāvas appeared in all His limbs. Within He was tasting bliss; outwardly He was overwhelmed.

59 As before, they all together brought Him back to consciousness. Rising, the Lord looked all around.

60 "Where has Kṛṣṇa gone? I saw Him just now — Him whose beauty has stolen My eyes and mind!

61 Why do I not see Him again, with the flute at His lips? My eyes wander about, greedy to see Him."

62 Then Mahāprabhu began to recite the verse that Rādhā had spoken to Viśākhā:

63 "O friend, His lustre shines brighter than a new cloud; His garment is more charming than new lightning; His face, with the gleaming, beautiful flute, is like the bright full moon of autumn; He is adorned with peacock feathers and radiant with a lovely necklace shining like stars — that enchanter of Madana fills My eyes with ever-growing longing." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.4)[10]

64 “Kṛṣṇa’s complexion is glossy as a new cloud and smooth as ground collyrium; it puts the blue lotus to shame with its softness. Surpassing every comparison, Kṛṣṇa’s lustre is supremely powerful: it steals the eyes and minds of all.

65 Tell Me, O friend, what shall I do? Kṛṣṇa is a wondrous cloud, and the *cātaka* birds of My eyes, not seeing Him, are dying of thirst.

66 His yellow cloth is the lightning, never steady; His pearl necklace is a lovely row of cranes; His peacock feather is a rainbow appearing above, and His Vaijayantī garland is another rainbow.

67 Hearing the soft murmur of His flute — the cloud’s sweet thunder — the peacocks of Vṛndāvana dance. And in that cloud a wondrous moon is rising, spotless and full in all its digits, its moonlight of beauty sparkling.

68 With a shower of the nectar of His pastimes it drenches all fourteen worlds — but when such a cloud appeared, the storm wind of My misfortune carried it away to another place, and the *cātaka* is dying, for it could not drink.”

69 “Alas, alas! Recite, recite, Rāmarāya!” the Lord said again, His voice choked with feeling. Rāmānanda recited a verse; hearing it, the Lord felt both joy and sorrow, and He Himself explained it.[11]

70 “Seeing Your face framed by curling locks and graced by the beauty of Your earrings, Your cheeks, the nectar of Your lips and Your smiling glance, and beholding Your two arms that grant fearlessness and Your chest, the sole delight of Śrī, we have become Your maidservants.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.39)[12]

71 “Having conquered the lotus and the moon, Kṛṣṇa has set the snare of His face, baited with the sweet smile of His lips. The women of Vraja

come, fall into the snare and become His maidservants, leaving shame, husbands, home and hearth.[13]

72 Ah, our friend Kṛṣṇa behaves like a hunter! He cares nothing for right or wrong, and with ruse after ruse He steals the hearts of women, His does.[14]

73 On His sparkling cheeks His *makara* earrings dance, and by that dance they steal the hearts of all women. With the arrows of His smiling sidelong glances He pierces their hearts, and He has no fear at all of killing women.

74 Kṛṣṇa's chest, lofty and broad and adorned with the marks of Lakṣmī and Śrīvatsa, is a robber: it carries off the minds and breasts of hundreds of thousands of goddesses of Vraja and skilfully makes them Hari's maidservants.[15]

75 Kṛṣṇa's two arms are graceful long bolts — no, not arms, but the bodies of black snakes. They slip into the gap between the two hills and bite women's hearts, and the women burn within from that poison.[16]

76 The palms of Kṛṣṇa's hands and the soles of His feet are cooler than millions of moons; they surpass camphor, vetiver root and sandal. A single touch of them destroys the burning poison of Smara, and women's hearts long for that touch."[17]

77 Lamenting so much in His dejection, Śrī Gaurahari recited a verse with this meaning — the verse with which Rādhā spoke to Viśākhā, laying open the grief of Her heart:

78 "O friend, His broad chest outshines a door of sapphire; His bolt-like arms take away the distress of young girls' minds tormented by Smara; His body is cooler than the moon, *hari-candana*, the lotus and camphor — that

enchanter of Madana kindles a longing in My breast." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.7)[18]

79 The Lord said, "I saw Kṛṣṇa just now, and by My own misfortune I have lost Him again.

80 Kṛṣṇa is fickle by nature; He does not stay in one place. He shows Himself, steals the mind and disappears."

81 "Seeing the gopīs intoxicated with their good fortune and grown proud, Keśava, to humble that pride and to show them His grace, vanished right there." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.48)[19]

82 He said to Svarūpa Gosāñi, "Sing a song that will bring My heart back to awareness."[20]

83 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi sweetly sang for the Lord a song from the *Gīta-govinda*:

84 "My mind remembers Hari, who here in the rāsa dance enjoyed His pastimes and His jests." (Gīta-govinda, 2.3)

85 When Svarūpa Gosāñi sang this song, the Lord rose, absorbed in prema, and began to dance.

86 The eight sāttvika-bhāvas appeared in His body, and all the *vyabhicārī-bhāvas*, beginning with joy, welled up.

87 Feelings arose (*bhāvodaya*), met (*bhāva-sandhi*) and mingled (*bhāva-śābalya*); feeling fought feeling in a great battle, each striving to prevail.[21]

88 Again and again He had that song sung; again and again He relished it and danced.

89 When the dancing had gone on in this way for a long time, Svarūpa Gosāñi brought the song to a close.

90 "Sing! Sing!" the Lord said again and again, but seeing His fatigue, Svarūpa Gosāñi did not sing.

91 The Lord kept saying, "Sing! Sing!" Hearing this, the devotees gathered all around and called out the name of Hari.

92 Then Rāmānanda Rāya made the Lord sit down and relieved His fatigue by fanning Him and serving Him in other ways.

93 Then they took the Lord to the seashore, bathed Him, and brought Him home again.

94 They gave the Lord His meal and had Him lie down to rest, and Rāmānanda and all the others went to their own places.

95 Thus I have told of the Lord's pastime in the garden that He entered, taking it for Vṛndāvana.[22]

96 Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi too has described this divine madness of the Lord, together with His lament:

97 "At times, on the shore of the ocean, at the sight of rows of gleaming gardens, He would remember again and again the forest of Vṛndāvana and be overwhelmed by the prema it awakened, His tongue moving restlessly as it repeated Kṛṣṇa's name. Will that Caitanya, the relisher of bhakti, come once again before my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka, 6)[23]

98 Śrī Caitanya's pastimes are endless; they cannot all be written. I only point the way and give a hint of them.

99 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: the ocean of feelings for Kṛṣṇa is unfathomable even for sages headed by Brahmā, for their knowledge rests on the senses. Heading in the edition: the Lord is immersed in the ocean of the mahābhāva of separation from Kṛṣṇa. ↩
2. *Anubhāṣya*: a potter's wheel goes on turning by the force of the first push, and the potter need not keep his hand on it; so the Lord's bodily actions went on naturally even when He had no awareness of the outer world. The comparison fits the daily life of the highest mahā-bhāgavata as long as he remains in this world. ↩
3. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: His form draws the eyes, His song the ears, His fragrance the nose, His taste the tongue and His touch the skin; all five transcendental qualities of Kṛṣṇa appeared at once to the Lord's five transcendental senses. ↩
4. Heading in the edition: Śrī Rādhā's words to Viśākhā. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: drawn by Kṛṣṇa, the senses conspire like five robbers: "Come, let us steal this wealth that belongs to another — the horse of the mind." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the senses know that Kṛṣṇa is another's man, and still each seeks to steal its own object in Him. ↩
6. *Guṇa* means both "quality" and "rope": sweetness binds the ears as with a rope. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa's playful speech treats women so unjustly that words cannot tell it. ↩
7. Heading in the edition: the meaning of the verse; the gopīs, wholly absorbed in Kṛṣṇa and separated from Him, search for Him and lament. ↩
8. The edition prints sakhī (a misprint; the vocative is *sakhi*, as in the Anubhāṣya: *he sakhi*). In the verse the beloved is not named; that She is Rādhā is said in verses 45–47 and in the Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: His left arm rests on His beloved's shoulder, and in His right hand He holds a lotus for play; the bees are blind with the intoxication of the nectar

they have drunk. ↩

10. *Anubhāṣya*: *tāra-hāra* — a necklace shining like bright stars. He is Madana, who intoxicates: to nourish the rasa of meeting He makes the beloved pine in separation and then makes the meeting fuller; and He is Mohana, who enchants by both — hence Madana-mohana. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: joy, because He hears of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness; sorrow, because He is separated from Him. ↩
12. The verse is Madhya 24.48; translated as there. ↩
13. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa has set the snare of His face to catch the does — the gopīs — and laid in it the bait of His sweet smile. The edition reads *mukha phānda* (no hyphen). ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "Ah, our friend Śrī Kṛṣṇa behaves just like a hunter!" These are words of loving reproach. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: Lakṣmī is a golden line on the left side of the chest; Śrīvatsa is a mark on the right side, a curl of hair turning to the right. ↩
16. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *mane*, "in the mind" (other editions *mare*, "die"). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: from the poison of this bite — His touch — the gopī burns with the fever of love's desire. ↩
17. The first line is the same as Madhya 2.34; translated as there. *Anubhāṣya*: *veṇā-mūla* is the fragrant *khaskhas* root (vetiver). ↩
18. Heading in the edition: Śrī Rādhā's words to Viśākhā — Her longing to see Kṛṣṇa. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: Keśava is He who brings under His sway *ka* and *īśa* — Brahmā and Śiva. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: *saṁvit* — when a troubled mind regains steady awareness. ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya*: *bhāvodaya* — the rise of the eight sāttvika-bhāvas; *bhāva-sandhi* — the meeting of two feelings, alike or different; *bhāva-śābalya* — the clash of many feelings with one another. ↩
22. Heading in the edition: the Lord's divine madness (*udghūrṇā* and *citra-jalpa*): thinking Himself a maidservant of the gopīs, He remembers the pastimes of Vṛndāvana. ↩
23. The last line is the same as Ādi 3.65 (Caitanyāṣṭaka, 1). *Anubhāṣya*: rows of gardens gleaming with beauty on the sandy shore of the ocean; His tongue is restless with the ceaseless kīrtana of the name "Kṛṣṇa". ↩